

Zoho Creator Admin Dashboard

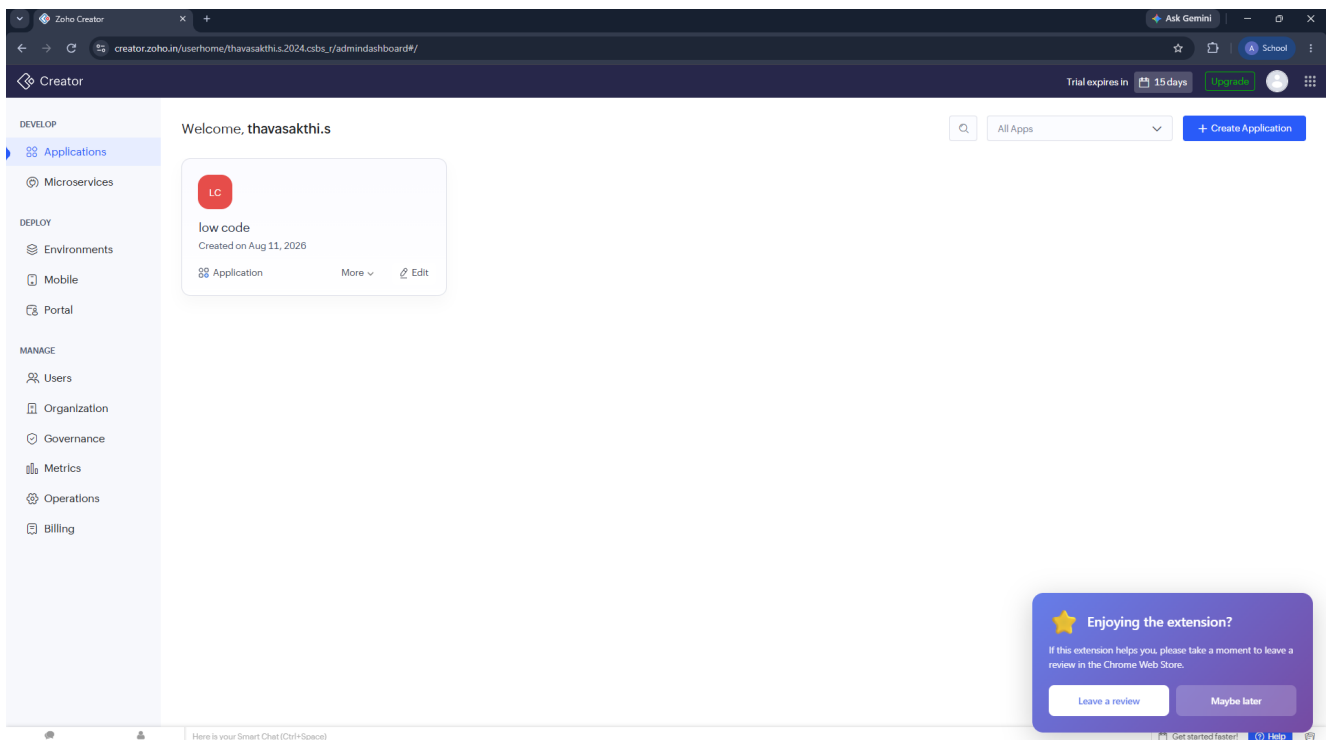
A Section-by-Section Walkthrough

This document walks through each section of the Zoho Creator admin dashboard sidebar — Applications, Microservices, Environments, Mobile, Portal, Users, Organization, Governance, Metrics, Operations, and Billing — with a screenshot of the screen followed by its Definition, Purpose, and a practical Use Case.

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1. Applications



Zoho Creator — Applications screen

Definition

The Applications section is the main landing page of the Zoho Creator admin dashboard. It lists every low-code/no-code application that has been created within the organization, showing details such as the app icon, name, and creation date.

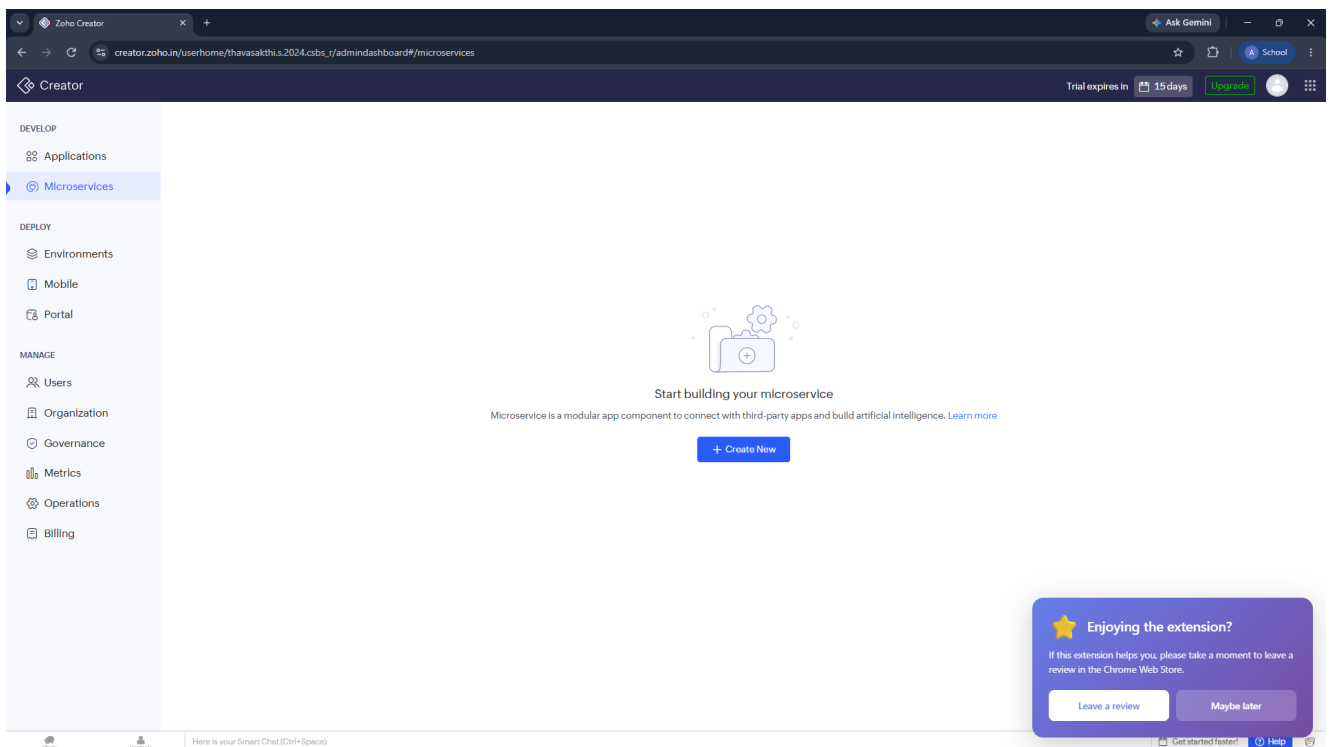
Purpose

Its purpose is to give the developer or administrator a central, at-a-glance view of all applications built in the account, along with quick access to open, edit, or manage each one.

Use Case

A school administrator building a 'Low Code' application for student or staff record management would use this screen to open the app for further development, or to create a brand-new application from scratch using the 'Create Application' button.

2. Microservices



Zoho Creator — Microservices screen

Definition

Microservices is a section where modular, reusable app components can be built to connect with third-party applications and integrate artificial intelligence capabilities into a solution.

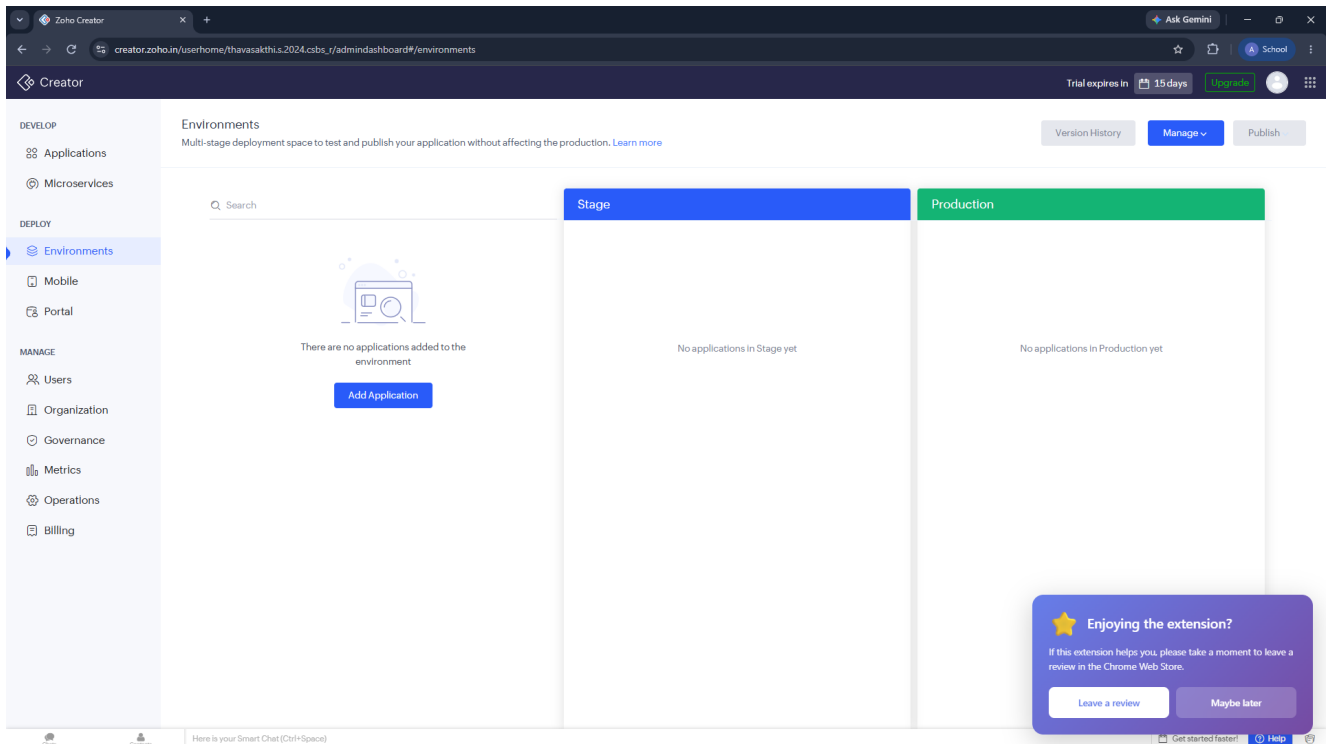
Purpose

The purpose of this feature is to let developers break functionality into small, independent, reusable services (such as an AI-powered chatbot or an external API connector) instead of embedding everything inside one monolithic application.

Use Case

A developer who wants to add an AI-based chat assistant or connect to an external payment or SMS gateway across multiple apps would create a microservice here so it can be reused wherever needed.

3. Environments



Zoho Creator — Environments screen

Definition

Environments provide a multi-stage deployment space consisting of a 'Stage' area and a 'Production' area, allowing applications to be tested before they go live.

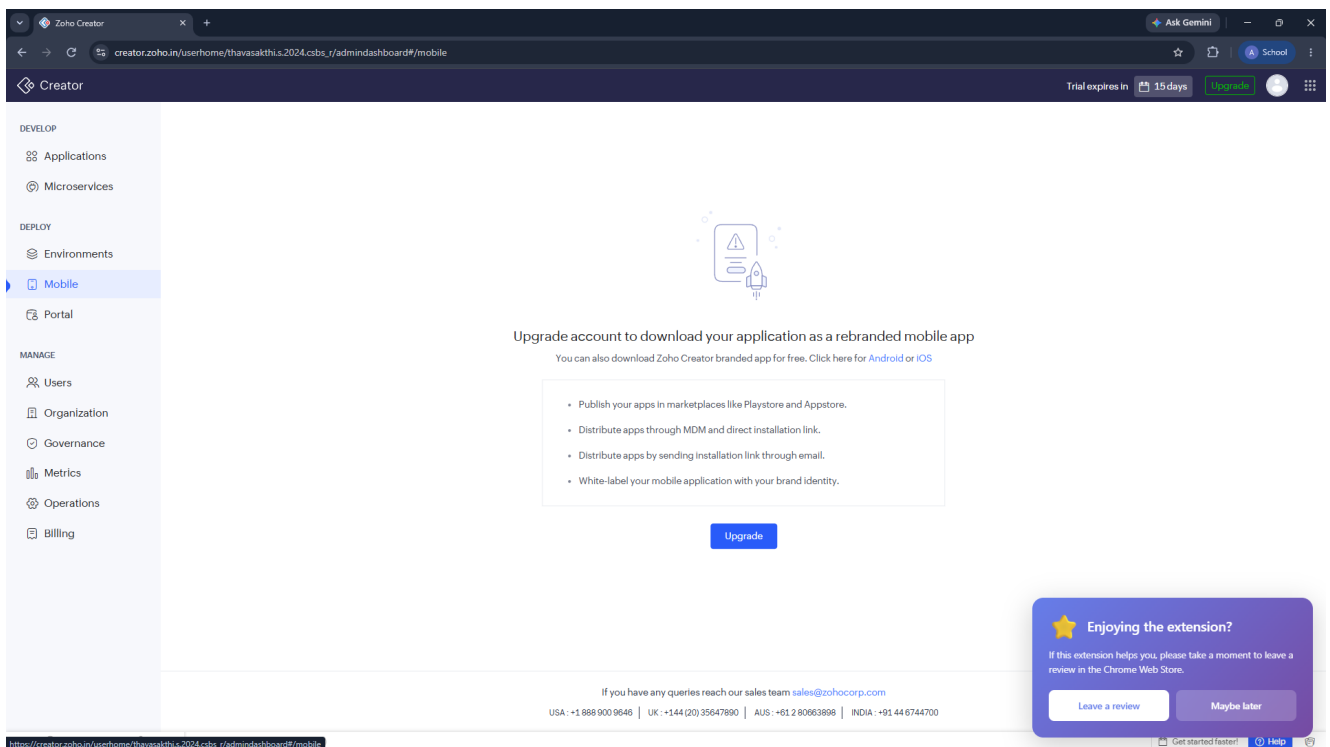
Purpose

The purpose is to let teams safely test changes, new features, or bug fixes in a Stage environment without affecting the live Production application that end users depend on.

Use Case

Before releasing an update to a student attendance app, the developer would add it to the Stage environment, test the new workflow, and only publish it to Production once it works correctly.

4. Mobile



Zoho Creator — Mobile screen

Definition

The Mobile section allows an application to be packaged and distributed as a rebranded (white-labeled) mobile app for Android and iOS, or downloaded as a generic Zoho Creator branded app.

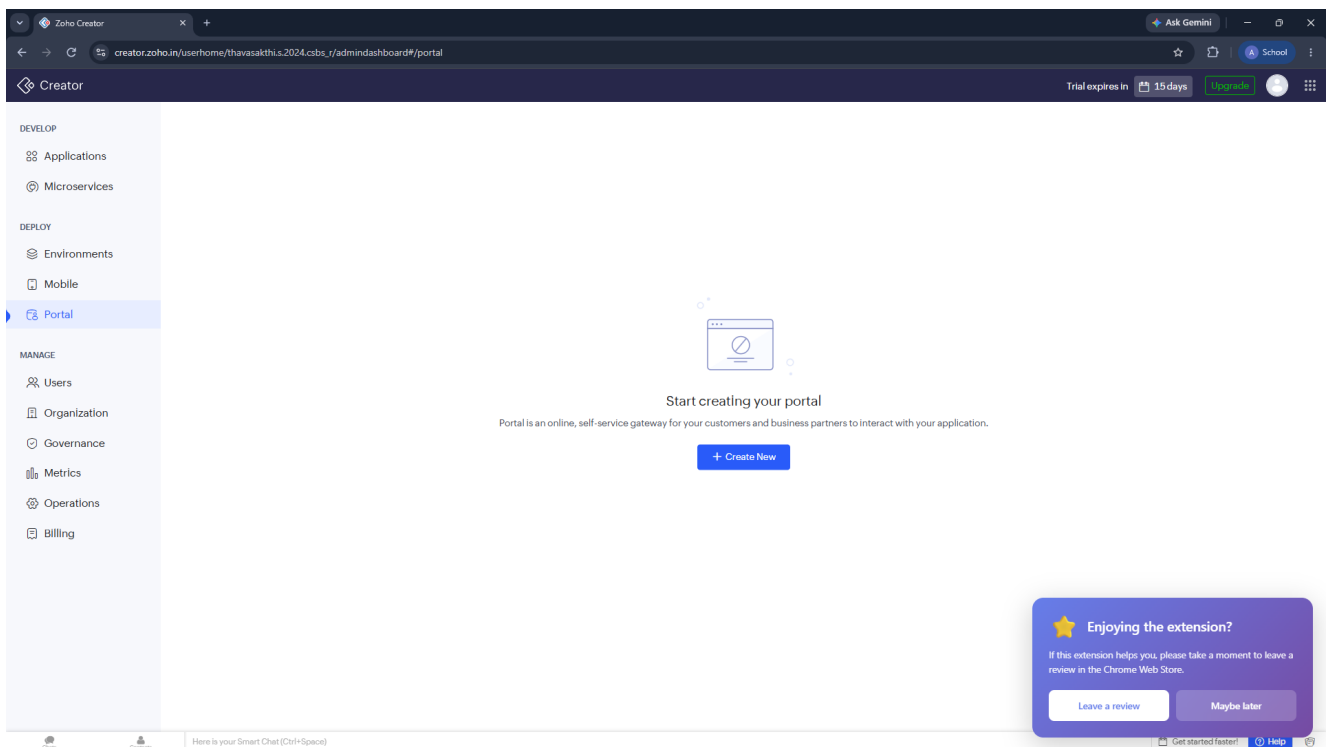
Purpose

Its purpose is to extend the reach of a Creator application beyond the browser by making it available as a native mobile app that can be published to app stores or distributed privately through MDM tools.

Use Case

An organization that wants its staff to access an internal inventory app from their phones, under its own company branding, would use this section to configure and publish the mobile version.

5. Portal



Zoho Creator — Portal screen

Definition

Portal is a self-service, customer/partner-facing gateway that lets external users interact with a specific application without being full internal users of the account.

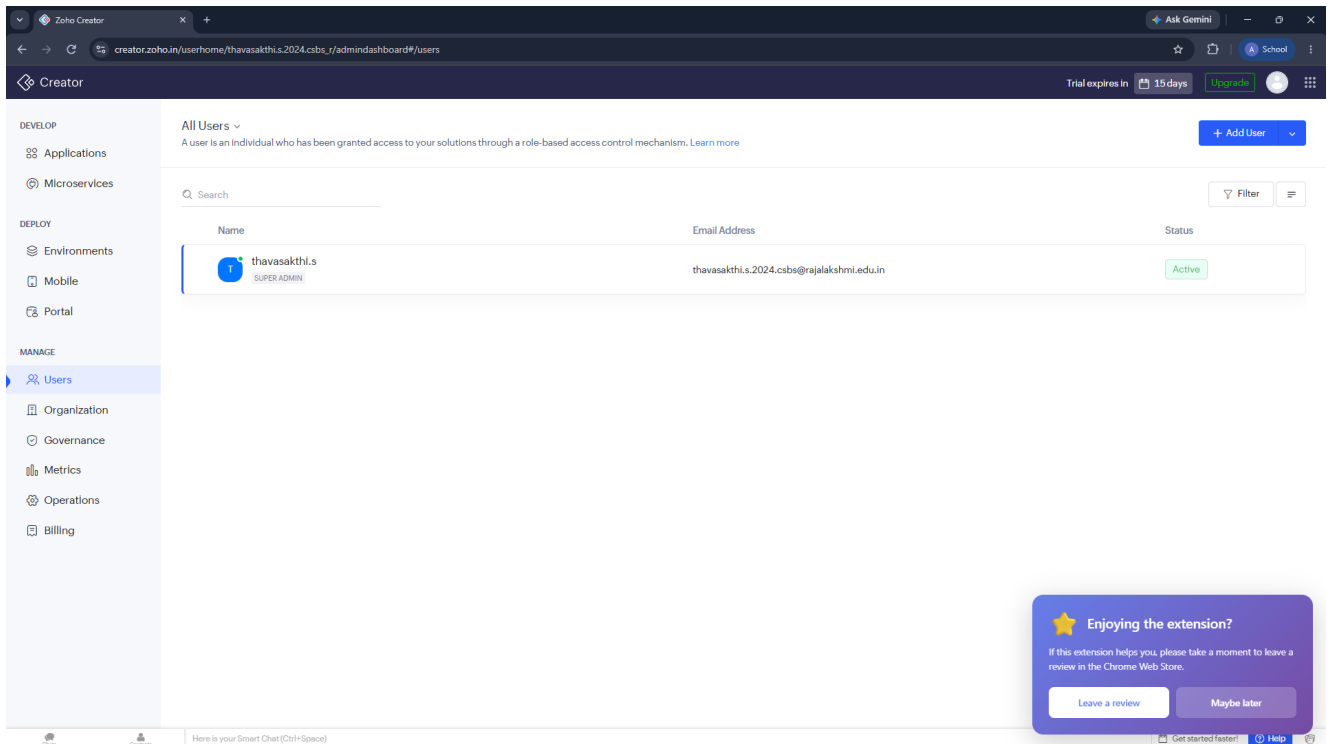
Purpose

The purpose of a Portal is to give customers, vendors, or partners restricted, controlled access to relevant parts of an application, such as submitting requests or viewing their own records.

Use Case

A college could create a Portal so that students or parents can log in externally to view fee status or submit an admission form, without being given full administrator access to the system.

6. Users



Zoho Creator — Users screen

Definition

The Users section lists everyone who has been granted access to the organization's applications, showing their name, email address, role (e.g., Super Admin), and account status.

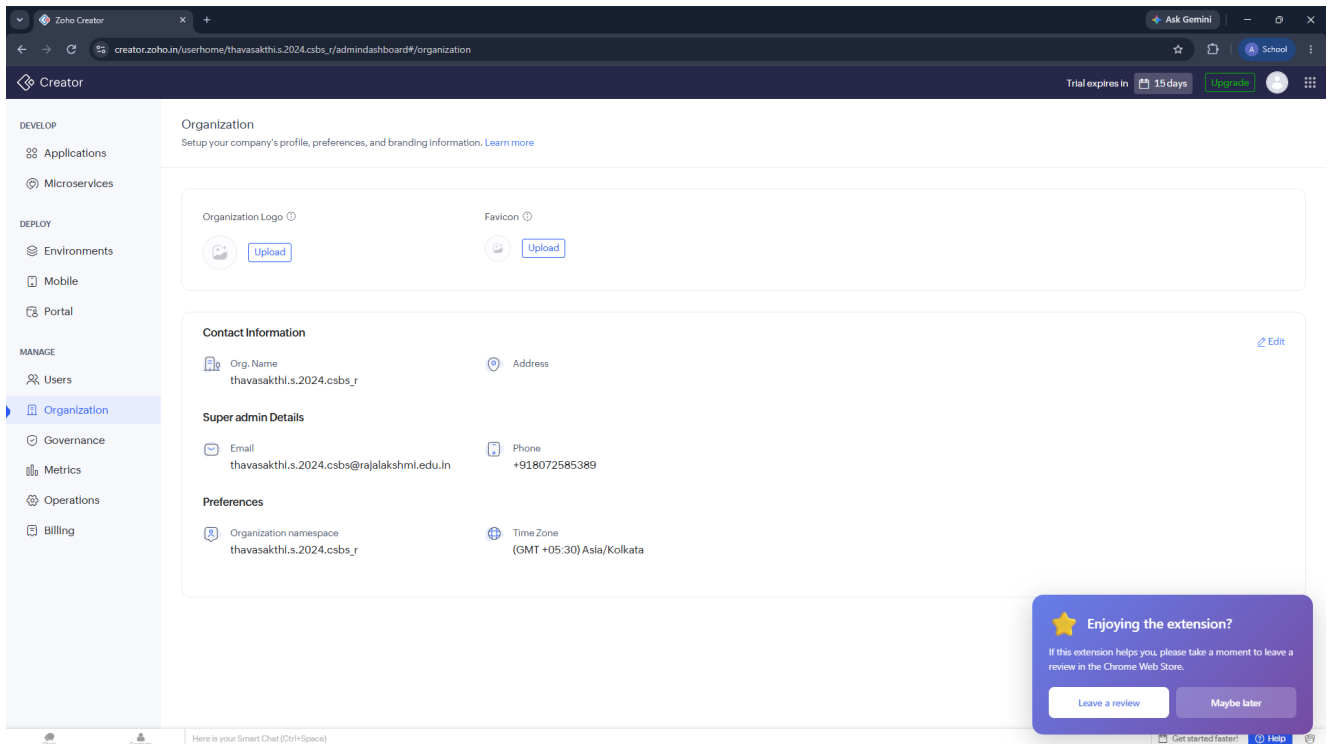
Purpose

Its purpose is role-based access control — managing who can log in, what role/permission level they hold, and whether their account is active, so that access to applications and data is properly governed.

Use Case

An admin adding a new teacher to a school management system would use the 'Add User' option here to invite them and assign an appropriate role such as Admin, Developer, or standard User.

7. Organization



Zoho Creator — Organization screen

Definition

Organization is the settings area where the company's profile, branding (logo and favicon), contact information, and preferences such as namespace and time zone are configured.

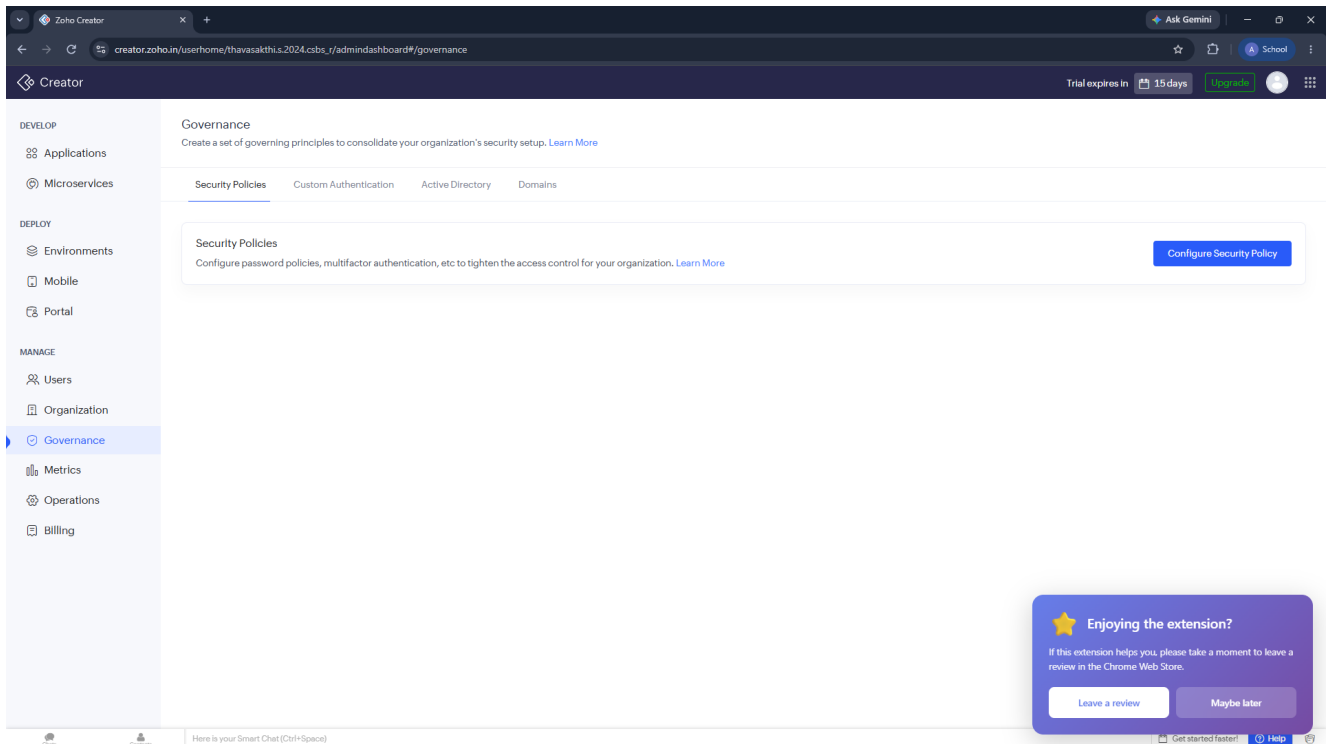
Purpose

The purpose is to centralize the identity and configuration details of the account — how the organization presents itself and which regional/administrative settings (like time zone) apply to it.

Use Case

A super admin setting up a fresh Zoho Creator account for their institution would come here to upload the organization's logo, set the correct time zone (e.g., Asia/Kolkata), and confirm contact details.

8. Governance



Zoho Creator — Governance screen

Definition

Governance is a section for creating security policies covering password rules, multi-factor authentication, custom authentication, Active Directory integration, and domain restrictions.

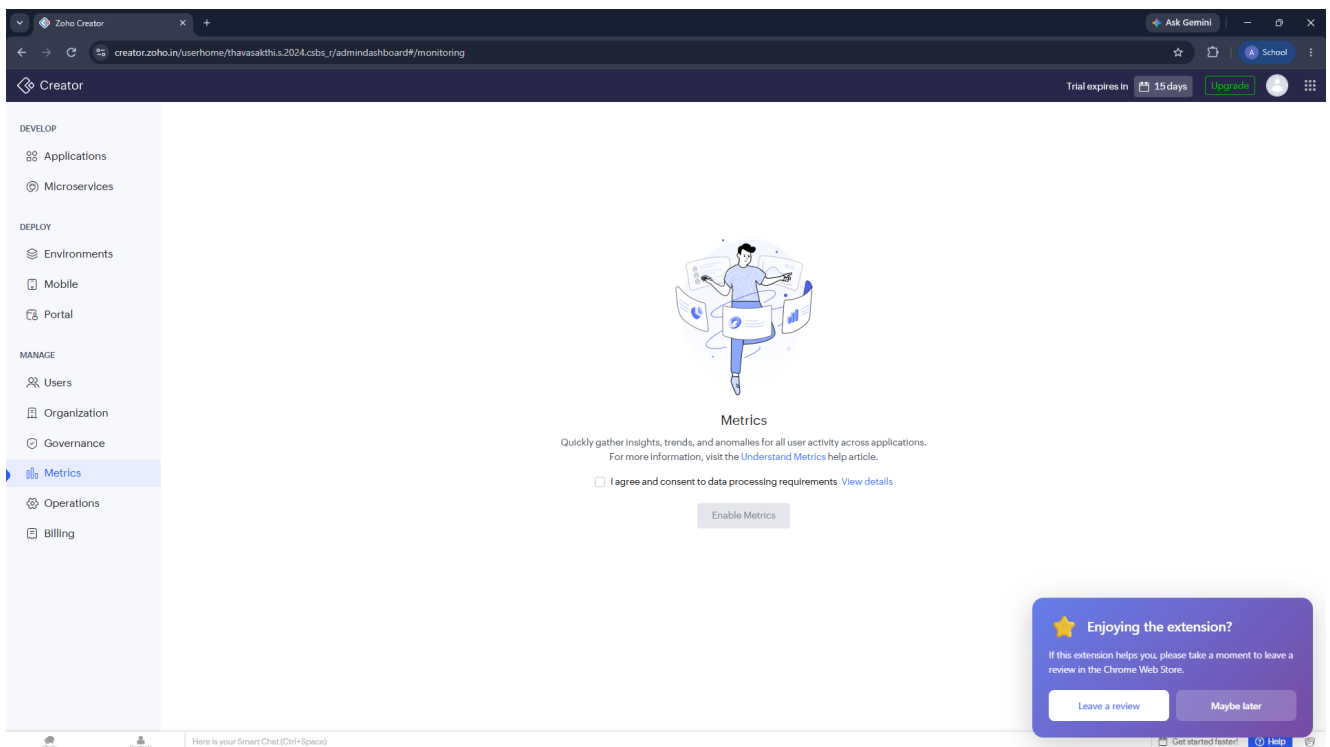
Purpose

Its purpose is to strengthen and standardize the organization's security posture by enforcing consistent access-control rules across all applications and users.

Use Case

An IT administrator concerned about unauthorized access would use 'Configure Security Policy' here to enforce strong passwords and mandatory multi-factor authentication for all users.

9. Metrics



Zoho Creator — Metrics screen

Definition

Metrics is a monitoring dashboard that gathers insights, trends, and anomalies related to user activity across all applications in the account, once enabled with the user's consent.

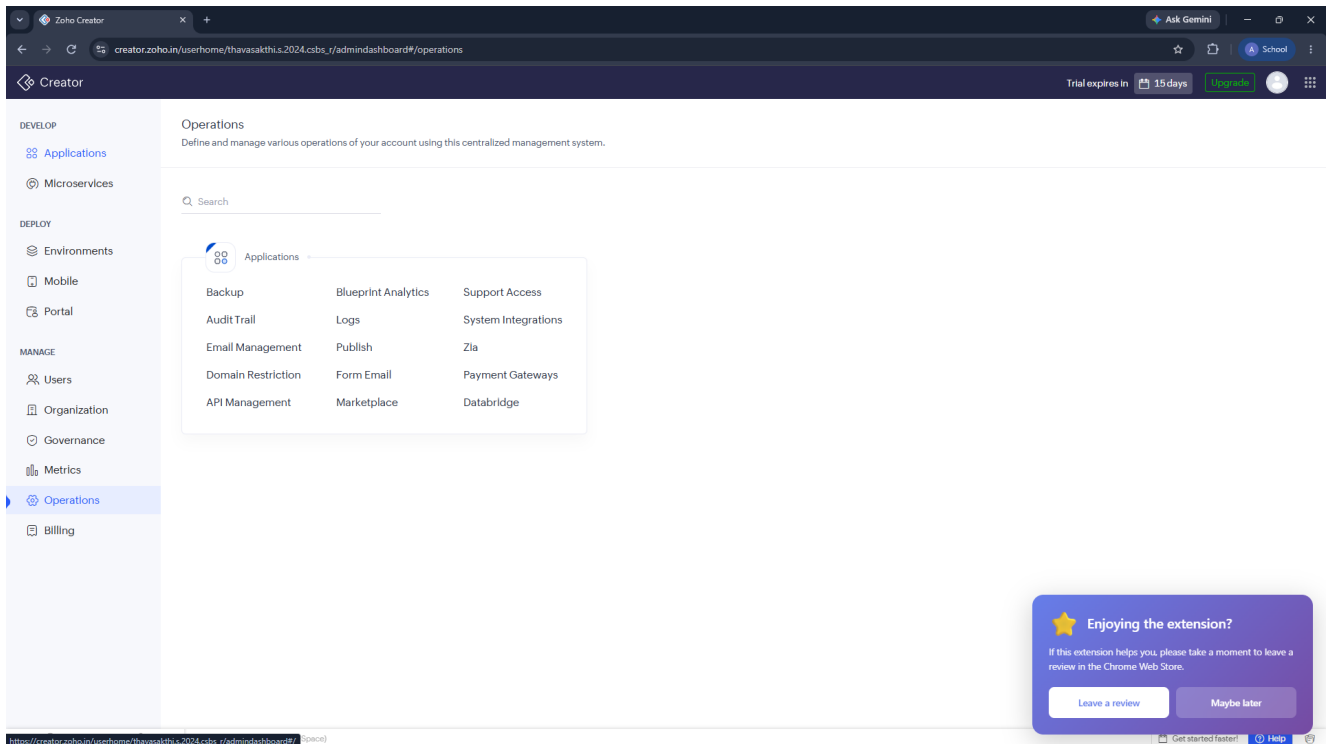
Purpose

The purpose is to give administrators visibility into how applications are being used — helping detect unusual activity, track adoption, and make data-informed decisions about the applications.

Use Case

Before a major rollout, an admin might enable Metrics to later review usage trends and spot any anomalies in how staff are interacting with a newly deployed application.

10. Operations



Zoho Creator — Operations screen

Definition

Operations is a centralized management panel covering account-level utilities such as Backup, Audit Trail, Email Management, Domain Restriction, API Management, Blueprint Analytics, Logs, Publish, Form Email, Marketplace, Support Access, System Integrations, Zia, Payment Gateways, and Databridge.

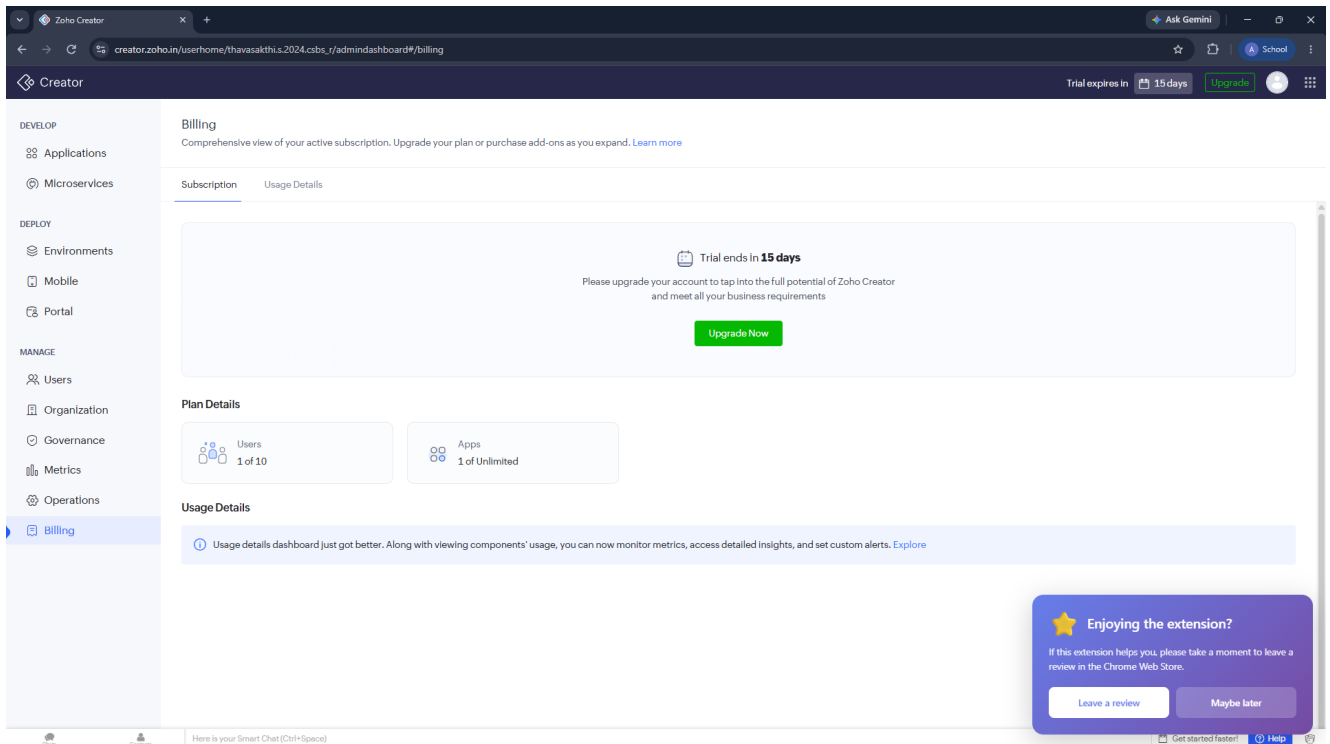
Purpose

Its purpose is to bring together the operational and administrative tools needed to maintain, secure, extend, and troubleshoot the applications and account as a whole.

Use Case

An administrator wanting to schedule regular backups of application data, or review the Audit Trail to see who changed a form, would use the relevant tool listed under Operations.

11. Billing



Zoho Creator — Billing screen

Definition

Billing gives a comprehensive view of the account's active subscription, including how many trial days remain, plan limits (such as number of users and apps allowed), and usage details.

Purpose

The purpose is to let the account owner track subscription status, understand current plan limitations, and decide when to upgrade to meet growing business or organizational requirements.

Use Case

Noticing the trial ends in 15 days and that the plan is limited to 10 users, an administrator planning to onboard more staff would use this screen to click 'Upgrade Now' and select a suitable paid plan.